

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM/EDR | Identity Security | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of progressive experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) operations, endpoint detection and response (EDR), and identity security hardening. I specialise in the Microsoft security stack, blending hands-on incident response with security engineering to drive measurable improvements in detection capability and overall security posture. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft 365 (M365), and Azure Entra ID, with a proven track record of leading complex threat investigations, triaging high-fidelity alerts, and hardening identity and access management (IAM), Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and Privileged Access Management (PAM) controls across large enterprise environments of 8,000+ users.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM/EDR:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL development, analytics rules, workbooks, playbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR
- **Microsoft Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Office 365 (M365), Defender XDR
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Entra ID, Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Identity Protection
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust Password Safe and Privileged Remote Access
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, Logic Apps, PowerShell automation
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Tanium, Windows/Linux endpoint hardening
- **Network Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast, IDS/IPS
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, senior escalation lead, playbook authoring
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+), JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead SIEM and EDR investigations using Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon, triaging and containing complex threats across cloud and on-premises environments for an 8,000-user estate
- Harden identity and access controls including Entra ID Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM) configuration, and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to eliminate standing privileged access
- Strengthen M365 security posture through Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Office 365, and Defender for Identity deployments, tuning, and ongoing management
- Author and maintain KQL-based analytics rules and SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate threat detection and streamline response workflows
- Serve as senior escalation point for high-priority security incidents, leading investigations end-to-end using the NIST 800-61 Incident Response (IR) framework; author and maintain IR playbooks and runbooks
- Manage enterprise vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, Pentera BAS, and AppCheck; prioritise findings and track remediation to closure in partnership with infrastructure teams
- Harden Windows and Linux endpoint baselines, manage patch management workflows, and validate remediation of penetration testing findings
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns across the organisation

- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Monitored and triaged security alerts in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, escalating confirmed incidents in line with SOC runbooks
- Built KQL queries and contributed to analytics rule development in Microsoft Sentinel to improve detection fidelity and reduce false positives
- Managed Intune MDM/MAM policies and Conditional Access configurations in Entra ID; enforced device compliance and identity-based access controls
- Assisted in BeyondTrust PAM implementation, supporting privileged account lifecycle management and access reviews
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) compliance activities including gap analysis, technical assessments, and evidence gathering
- Supported security awareness initiatives including phishing simulations and targeted training campaigns

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Implemented and maintained security policies, access controls, and identity management within a SaaS/FinTech environment
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and supported remediation of identified security risks across infrastructure
- Managed infrastructure security including network access controls, endpoint protection, and security configuration hardening
- Supported quality assurance processes and ensured system configurations adhered to internal security standards

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel across 8,000-user estate, building a hybrid Security Operations Centre (SOC) with 24/7 alert coverage and reducing Mean Time to Detect (MTTD) by 40%
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM eliminating standing privileged access for 200+ administrator accounts, significantly reducing privilege-based attack surface
- Authored SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel automating phishing triage and alert enrichment, reducing analyst triage time from 45 minutes to under 5 minutes per incident
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) certification programme to successful accreditation, remediating technical gaps across identity, endpoint, network, and patch management controls
- Implemented enterprise-wide MFA and Conditional Access policy framework via Entra ID, eliminating password-only authentication across all cloud services and reducing account compromise risk

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate